

Today, David has crushed his goal of financial independence. With a net worth of \$2.2 million, he and his wife have not one but two paid-for houses, spending part of the year in their Colorado vacation home. David still works, but he does it for fun and only part time. When we asked him what he tells his students about building wealth, he said he always points back to the goals he had early on. He explained that most people have unrealistic expectations of retirement and eventually find themselves unprepared. You can't enjoy retirement or reach financial independence, he warns, if you don't plan ahead. "You need to know how much you want to spend—and then you need to make sure you have more saved than you plan to spend when you get there." Simple advice that, I hate to say, too many people just don't—or won't—follow.

WORKING TOWARD MILLIONAIRE GOALS

Again, *anyone* can become a millionaire in this country, but it won't happen by accident. It takes time, intentionality, a little financial intelligence, and goals. If you have those things, anything's possible. Understand that a goal is simply a promise you make to yourself. I hope by now that you've made that promise, that you have accepted the call to join the ranks of America's millionaires. It may seem like a lofty goal to set, but trust me, it's possible. My purpose in this chapter has been to get you to start picturing that millionaire life for yourself and to help you set some long-term goals to get there. If you take these things to heart, I know you can cross that millionaire finish line. Too many people look at the challenges and distractions all around us and ask, "How can I ever become a millionaire?" That's not your question, though. From now on, I want you to start asking yourself, "*How soon* can I become a millionaire?" Equipped with your new mind-set, you can start setting those short- and long-term goals that will get you there.